

Six levels of AI-native productivity

How much AI has improved what your team gets done – not how advanced its tools are.

PRODUCTIVITY USEFUL RESULTS FOR THE FULL EFFORT, TIME, ATTENTION AND COST – REVIEW AND REWORK INCLUDED

0

No useful AI-enabled gain is established

People use AI, but checking and fixing its output eats the time it saves.

NOT YET a gain that survives checking. This says nothing about how good the team is.

ENABLED BY personal chat assistants · context pasted by hand

1

AI produces useful gains in parts of the work

Individual tasks get faster or better – a draft, an analysis, code – and hold up in review.

NOT YET a better whole deliverable. Handoffs, waiting and rework absorb the gain.

ENABLED BY assistants connected to the tools, documents and data the work needs

2

AI improves complete, worthwhile results

Whole deliverables arrive sooner or better – or become possible at all – and people use them, counting everyone's effort.

NOT YET gains across the team. Work competing for the same people still collides.

ENABLED BY agents run a defined process, people sign off · checks against “done” · least-privilege access

3

AI-enabled collaboration increases what the organization can accomplish together

The same people deliver more valuable work. AI catches clashes across projects and follows up, so everyone spends less time chasing.

NOT YET ongoing improvement across cycles. The same problems keep coming back.

ENABLED BY shared agents in the team's channels · skills, schedules and follow-up · scoped permissions and audit

4

AI helps the organization keep improving how it works

Across cycles, the work measurably improves – less rework, shorter cycle times. AI finds repeat problems, proposes fixes and checks them; people's skills grow.

NOT YET a reliable link between better delivery and better strategic choices.

ENABLED BY work tracked across cycles: cycle time, rework, repeat problems · agent telemetry

5

Strategy and delivery improve each other

Direction changes reach the work fast, results from the work change the direction, and poor bets stop earlier.

KEEP GOING find where people still carry information up or down by hand.

ENABLED BY strategy and delivery data linked · governance by role · private models where needed

Keep one unit in mind. Rate one team, department or company at every level – “organization” means that unit. Each level keeps the gains below it.

Show it, don't claim it. Every level needs evidence. In one trial (METR 2025), developers felt 20% faster with AI and were 19% slower.

Tools enable – people decide. “Enabled by” lists typical setups, not requirements; off-the-shelf AI goes far. How well people set it up and use it decides the level.

Where does your team stand?



See each level in practice, how to recognize yours, and what moves you up.

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